

Adobe Firefly Japan Use Case Page Culturalisation

Web PM

Culturalisation

UX Content Strategy

Adobe Analytics

Contentsquare

Role

Web Product Manager

Company

Adobe Japan

Year

2025

Team

Marketing · Creative Agency
· Global CMS

The Problem

Adobe Firefly's global website was built around Western visual references — models, aesthetics, creative scenarios, and lifestyle imagery that felt distant to Japanese users. For a product whose core value is *'imagine what you could create'*, the lack of cultural identification was a significant barrier to engagement. Japanese users, particularly young SNS-native creators, could not see themselves in the product.

The Goal

Create a Japan-specific Firefly use case page that:

- Spoke directly to young Japanese SNS creators (Instagram, TikTok, X)
- Showcased use cases relevant to their creative workflows
- Used culturalised imagery that felt native, not translated
- Drove page engagement and app referral clicks

Target Audience

Young Japanese creators who use SNS platforms (Instagram, TikTok, X) to showcase original content — a rapidly growing, digitally native segment with high creative tool affinity and strong sensitivity to visual and cultural authenticity.



Key Insight: Localisation is not translation. For Firefly to resonate with Japanese creators, users needed to see people like themselves, creating content they recognised, in contexts they lived in.

My Role & Process

I led this project end-to-end as Web PM — from audience strategy and creative direction through to build, QA, launch, and post-launch performance tracking.

1 Discovery & Gap Analysis

Reviewed Firefly global page performance for Japan. Identified a clear engagement gap driven by cultural disconnection — imagery and use cases that did not reflect Japanese creators or their workflows.

2 Audience Definition

Defined the primary persona: young Japanese SNS creators (Instagram, TikTok, X) who create original content and are highly sensitive to visual authenticity. This persona shaped every content and creative decision.

3 Use Case Mapping with Marketing

Collaborated with the Japan marketing team to identify the most relevant creative scenarios for this audience: SNS video creation, product image generation, BGM & sound effects, and storyboarding — structured into the page's section architecture.

4 Creative Direction & Agency Briefing

Briefed a creative agency with detailed culturalisation guidelines. Defined scenarios, talent direction, aesthetics, and visual contexts that would feel authentically Japanese — not superficially swapped stock imagery.

5 Copy Localisation

Worked with copywriters to ensure Japanese copy matched the tone of young SNS creators — casual, aspirational, and direct — rather than a literal translation of global marketing language.

6 Build, QA & Launch

Coordinated page build with the global CMS team. Managed QA across devices and breakpoints. Oversaw launch and coordinated stakeholder sign-off from both Japan and global teams.

7 Post-Launch Performance Tracking

Monitored engagement and app referral clicks post-launch using Adobe Analytics and Contentsquare. Reported results to Japan and global stakeholders.



Culturalised hero with Japanese model, Japanese-language headline targeting SNS creators

Use case: creating videos for social media — storyboard → generate → post

Use case: generating product imagery for e-commerce and campaigns

Use case: adding background music and sound effects to video content

Pricing plans and CTA — localised tier names and pricing in JPY

■ Engagement — users spent significantly more time interacting with the culturalised use case content vs. the previous globally-templated page

■ **App referral clicks —** click-through to Firefly app entry points increased post-launch, indicating stronger intent among Japanese visitors



Stakeholder recognition — positively received by Japan and global teams as a model for market-specific culturalisation within Adobe's web ecosystem

Key Takeaway

Effective culturalisation requires understanding *who* the user is, *what* they aspire to create, and *how* they see themselves — then building an experience that reflects that identity back to them. This project demonstrated that audience-first content strategy, paired with intentional creative direction, can meaningfully close the gap between a global product and a local user.